

UTTAR PRADESH

EMERGES AS A HUB OF CULTURAL TOURISM

Under the double-engine government, cultural tourism in Uttar Pradesh has moved far beyond the mere development of sites. It has evolved into a new model where heritage preservation, modern amenities and the local economy advance together. The policies of the Yogi government have clearly demonstrated that faith and development are not opposing forces, but natural partners. Tourism is no longer confined to religious belief alone; it has emerged as a strong driver of employment, local enterprise and regional growth. This is the new paradigm of cultural tourism in Uttar Pradesh under the double-engine government.

Tourist footfall in Uttar Pradesh rose from 21.5 crore in 2016 to 64.9 crore in 2024, marking an extraordinary growth of more than three times in just seven years.

Uttar Pradesh's share in India's total tourist inflow, which stood at 25.6% in 2003, declined to 13.1% in 2016, but made a strong comeback to 18.99% in 2023.

During Mahakumbh 2025, over 66.30 crore devotees from India and abroad took a holy dip at the Sangam, presenting India's ancient tradition as a global heritage event.

Uttar Pradesh emerged as the most visited state in the country. From January to December 2024, a total of 66 crore tourists visited the state, including over 14 lakh foreign tourists.

At Deepotsav Ayodhya 2025, more than 26.17 lakh lamps were lit, once again creating a Guinness World Record. The establishment of a world-class temple museum is currently underway.

Recognition for landmark initiatives such as the Shri Kashi Vishwanath Dham Corridor in Varanasi, Ayodhya Deepotsav, Braj Rangotsav, and Dev Deepawali in Kashi.

Construction of the Vindhyachal Dham Corridor in Mirzapur; revival of Naimish Tirth and Shukr Tirth; reinstallation of the idol of Maa Annapurna after 100 years; and development of the Soron-Sukar region.

Development of major fairs including Lakkhi Mela at Shri Dau Ji Maharaj in Hathras, Makar Sankranti and Basant Panchami fairs in Ayodhya, and the Kartik Purnima Ganga Snan Mela at Anupshahr, Bulandshahr.

Establishment of museums in Kaushambi and at the ancestral home of Padma Shri Babu KD Singh in Barabanki; construction of the Gorkha Regiment Centre, and a martyrs' memorial and museum in Gorakhpur, now in the final stage.